Achievement EHCP TARGET progression mapping

Shape Strand Overview

The shape strand focuses on developing pupils' understanding of the properties, recognition and use of shapes. It begins with exploratory play and manipulation of objects, progressing towards recognising, describing and selecting shapes for specific purposes. Pupils develop the ability to combine, analyse and reason about shapes in practical and problem-solving contexts.

Why is it important?

Shape supports construction and design, problem solving, and understanding geometry.

Without this - pupils may struggle to recognise shapes or use them purposefully

With it - pupils can select, combine and reason about shapes effectively

Pathway Aim

By the end of the pathway, pupils will be able to recognise, describe and use shapes and their properties to solve problems and construct ideas in a range of contexts.

Example Evidence Statements

"The pupil selects shapes for specific purposes and explains their choices."

"They recognise shapes even when rotated or viewed differently."

"They use shapes to represent real-world objects in their constructions."

Shape Exploration & Manipulation (Bands 1–3)	**Shape Recognition & Early Properties (Bands 4–5)**	**Shape Properties & Construction (Band 6)**	**Shape Reasoning & Application (Band 7)**
Pupils explore shapes through sensory play, handling and interacting with different objects, developing early awareness of shape and how objects fit together.	Pupils begin to recognise common shapes and describe them using informal and then more formal language. They use shapes purposefully in construction and problem solving.	Pupils explore and describe shape properties, sort shapes based on features and use shapes to solve problems in construction and design.	Pupils use shape knowledge intentionally, explaining choices and applying understanding to problem solving, construction and representation.

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Key stage Target By the end of the key stage, the pupil will explore and interact with shapes and objects, showing awareness of how they fit together and relate to space.	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will recognise and describe common shapes and use them appropriately in practical contexts.	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will describe, compare and use shapes based on their properties to solve problems.	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will use and explain shape properties to solve problems and represent objects in different contexts.
Typical evidence might include: placing shapes into containers or sorters stacking and balancing objects trial-and-error fitting shapes into spaces exploring how shapes connect	**Typical evidence might include:** naming or identifying basic shapes selecting appropriate shapes during building describing shapes using simple language combining shapes to create structures	**Typical evidence might include:** sorting shapes by features describing properties (sides, curves) building structures with increasing complexity recognising simple symmetry	**Typical evidence might include:** explaining why a specific shape was chosen recognising shapes in different orientations representing real objects using shapes solving problems in construction
Mapped curriculum targets **Band 1** Explore objects of different shapes and sizes Put objects inside others and remove them **Band 2** Stack objects using flat surfaces Attempt to match shapes to spaces **Band 3** Fit shapes into spaces (e.g. puzzles, sorters) Select shapes for spaces Use blocks to build structures Match objects that fit together	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 4** Choose puzzle pieces and attempt to fit them Make simple constructions **Band 5** Recognise common shapes (circle, square, triangle) Use informal shape language (e.g. pointy, curved) Select shapes for purpose Combine and partition shapes Build structures using trial and improvement	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 6** Describe shapes using mathematical language (e.g. straight, curved) Sort shapes by properties Combine shapes to make new shapes Recognise symmetry Build more complex models Solve problems using shapes	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 7** Select shapes intentionally for purpose Explain construction choices Represent objects using shapes Recognise shapes in different orientations Solve practical problems using shapes

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Next Step: Begin to recognise and describe shapes using simple language	**Next Step:** Begin to classify and describe shapes using properties	**Next Step:** Use shape knowledge to explain decisions and solve more complex problems	**Next Step:** Apply shape knowledge to describe properties, classify shapes and solve problems in more formal mathematical contexts (Celebration)